



Daystar University
May- July 2026 Trimester
Theology of Work and Development
THEO 401A

Date: Monday 8th June 2026

Lesson 3: Theology of Human Dignity and Work

Learning Objectives

1. - Understand the biblical foundation of human dignity
2. - Explore how human dignity informs the theology of work
3. - Examine key biblical texts related to human worth and labor
4. - Reflect on contemporary implications for work and social justice

Introduction

1. - Human dignity as a core biblical concept
2. - Connection between being made in God's image and the value of work
3. - The importance of integrating theology with social and economic practices

Human Dignity in the Bible

1. - Genesis 1:26-27: Humanity created in God's image (Imago Dei)
2. - Implication: Every person possesses inherent worth and dignity, regardless of status or work

Imago Dei and Its Significance

1. - Meaning of Imago Dei: Reflecting God's character—creative, relational, moral
2. - Application to Work: - Work is an expression of human creativity and stewardship

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- Every person's labor has intrinsic value because they are made in God's likeness

Biblical Support for Human Dignity

- - **Psalm 8:** Humanity's exalted position in creation
- - **James 3:9:** Humanity made to reflect God's glory
- - **Matthew 25:31-46:** The value of every individual, especially the marginalized (sheep and goats)

The Fall and Its Impact on Human Dignity

- - Genesis 3: Sin distorts human relationships and work
- - Consequences: Exploitation, injustice, dehumanization in society and labor practices
- - Key Point: Dignity is challenged but not lost; redemption is possible

The Biblical View of Work and Dignity

- - Work as a divine calling and partnership with God
- - Dignity of all types of work, including manual labor, caregiving, and service
- - The prophetic emphasis on justice for workers and the oppressed

Justice and Human Dignity in Biblical Law

- - Leviticus 19:13-18: Fair treatment of workers and neighbors
- - Deuteronomy 24:14-15: Justice for hired workers
- - Jubilee (Leviticus 25): Restoring dignity through economic and social resets

Jesus and Human Dignity

- - Jesus' ministry highlights the dignity of the marginalized
- - Healing, serving, and calling individuals by name (e.g., Zacchaeus, the woman at the well)
- - Matthew 20:25-28: Servant leadership as a model for work

Paul's Theology of Work

- - Colossians 3:23-24: Work done for the Lord

- - Ephesians 6:5-9: Slaves and masters, mutual respect, dignity in all relationships
- - Vocation as calling: Every believer's work has spiritual significance

Contemporary Implications

- - Recognizing the dignity of every worker
- - Promoting ethical work environments
- - Addressing issues like exploitation, inequality, and injustice
- - Work as participation in God's ongoing creation and redemption

Group After class Discussions and Presentations

- - How does the doctrine of Imago Dei influence your view of work?
- - In what ways does recognizing human dignity impact social justice efforts?
- - How can faith inform ethical practices in the workplace?